

Verified SEO Audit — rollyourownpapers.com

Date: 2026-05-21 **Basis:** Real data — Shopify theme export, homepage HTML source, Google Search Console performance export (Feb 19–May 19, 2026, "Last 3 months") **Supersedes:** The March 16 and May 21 *external-inference* reports. Where they conflict, **this report is correct** — it is built on first-party data, not search-result guesses.

! Corrections to the Earlier Reports

The March/May audits were done with no access to the site (HTTP 403). Several of their "critical" findings were wrong. With real data:

Earlier claim	Reality (verified)
"No schema markup"	✗ Wrong — <code>WebSite</code> + <code>Product</code> JSON-LD exist; GSC shows Merchant listings at pos 3.2
"Meta descriptions missing"	✗ Wrong — homepage has a proper, well-written meta description
"robots.txt 403 = critical Googlebot crawl risk"	✗ Overstated — Google crawls fine: 3.17M impressions, 980+ pages indexed. The 403 only blocks the audit sandbox (and possibly AI crawlers)
"Tag/filter pages wrongly indexed"	✗ Wrong — theme correctly applies <code>noindex, follow</code> to tag pages (<code>theme.liquid:12-14</code>)
"Homepage title bloated"	✗ Already fine — <code>Custom Rolling Papers & Pre-Rolled Cones \ Low Minimums</code>
" <code>\ </code> within: collection URL bug"	✓ Confirmed — 8 instances in the theme
"Blog is too consumer-focused"	✓ Confirmed — and far worse than estimated (see below)

Net: the earlier reports inflated technical/infrastructure problems and under-weighted the one structural problem that actually explains everything. That problem is below.

The Real Diagnosis: A Traffic–Intent Mismatch

RYOP does **not** have a traffic problem. In the last 3 months it got **~45,500 organic clicks** on **3.17M impressions**. It has a **monetization problem**: the traffic is going to the wrong pages, for the wrong queries, from the wrong audience.

Where the 45,500 clicks actually land (GSC Pages export)

Page type	Pages indexed	Clicks (3 mo)	Share
Blog posts	684	42,134	92.5%
Homepage	1	2,079	4.6%

Page type	Pages indexed	Clicks (3 mo)	Share
Product pages	256	942	2.1%
Collection pages	46	612	1.3%

92.5% of all organic traffic goes to informational blog content. The pages that actually sell — collections + products — pull 3.4% combined.

The blog isn't just consumer-focused — it's anti-commercial

The single biggest page on the entire site:

/blogs/.../what-to-use-as-rolling-paper-when-you-re-out-of-papers-10-handy-alternatives — **10,544 clicks, 352,162 impressions.**

That post teaches people how to *avoid buying rolling papers*. The rest of the top blog pages are the same: "how to make a joint without rolling paper", "alternatives to rolling paper", "can you use parchment paper / toilet paper / gum wrappers", "how to make rolling paper at home", "how much is a bag of weed", "can you fly with weed". This pulls in hobbyist consumers — **none of whom will ever place a 150-booklet custom B2B order.**

The result: Google has miscategorized the site

With 684 informational posts vs. 92 commercial pages, Google reads rollyourownpapers.com as an **informational blog about rolling-paper alternatives and weed culture** — not a **B2B custom manufacturer**. The site's topical authority, internal links, and crawl budget are all concentrated in the wrong place.

The "custom rolling paper / papers" Keywords — Verified Numbers

You asked specifically about these. Here is the GSC truth (3-month average position):

Query	Position	Clicks	Impressions
custom rolling papers	9.45	385	2,891
custom rolling papers low minimum	9.29	63	290
custom rolling papers with logo	7.43	22	144
custom rolling paper	12.61	40	418
branded rolling papers	16.55	17	541
custom printed rolling papers	16.18	14	363
custom rolling papers wholesale	15.69	5	136
custom rolling paper manufacturer	5.25	9	107

And the page that *should* own these terms:

/collections/custom-rolling-papers — **position 18.5**, 101 clicks, 8,139 impressions.

This is the core finding. "custom rolling papers" sits at position **9.45** (bottom of page 1) — but it's being carried by the **homepage**, not the product collection. The collection page built to rank for that exact term is stuck on **page 2 (pos 18.5)**.

You don't have a penalty. You have a **starved commercial page** competing — weakly — against rivals (Papers+Ink, Snail, Hara, The Rolling Paper Company) who run dedicated, content-rich, well-linked custom-rolling-paper pages. RYOP's equivalent page is out-resourced by its own 684-post blog.

Is it a "drop"? — Honest answer

The GSC export was set to **"Last 3 months"** (Feb 19–May 19). Within that window, performance is **stable** — ~500–750 clicks/day, average position 4.2–5.6, no cliff. **I cannot see your 6-month trend** from this file. If you want the true 6-month comparison, re-export GSC with a **custom 6-month (or 16-month) date range**.

But the structural read is clear regardless: "custom rolling papers" at pos 9.45 with the collection page at 18.5 is not a sudden algorithmic collapse — it's a page that was **never built to win**. Any drift from, say, pos 6–7 to pos 9–10 is competitors strengthening while RYOP's commercial pages stood still.

Confirmed Technical Issues (from the theme export)

1. The | within: collection URL-splitting bug — CONFIRMED

Every product link from a collection points to a non-canonical URL (/collections/x/products/y instead of /products/y), splitting ranking signals. Found in **8 places**:

File	Line(s)
sections/featured-collection.liquid	68
snippets/product-grid-item.liquid	82, 337
snippets/product-grid-item-video.liquid	82, 340
snippets/product-template.liquid	66, 662
snippets/onboarding-product-grid-item.liquid	3

Fix: in each, change `{{ product.url | within: collection }}` → `{{ product.url }}` (and `{{ variant.url | within: collection }}` → `{{ variant.url }}`). The canonical tag already points to the clean URL, so this just stops leaking link equity.

2. Homepage H1 is the logo

Homepage line 1052 : the `<h1>` wraps the site logo (`<span class="visually-hidden">Roll Your Own Papers</span>`). A second `<h1>` ("Bring your...") sits in the AI-generated hero. The primary H1 should be a descriptive, keyword-bearing heading like *"Custom Rolling Papers & Pre-Roll Cones — Low Minimums, Factory Direct"*, with only one H1 per page.

3. Schema is present but thin

- ✓ `Website` JSON-LD exists — but bare (no `SearchAction` /sitelinks search box).
- ✓ `Product` + `offer` JSON-LD on featured products.
- ✗ No `Organization` JSON-LD (only legacy microdata on the logo, using insecure `http://schema.org`). Add a full `Organization` block: founding date, logo, `sameAs` (Trustpilot, Instagram), and the TÜV SÜD credential.
- ✗ No `BreadcrumbList` on collection/product pages.

4. Product snippets rank at position 59

GSC "Search appearance": Product snippets show **15,214 impressions at average position 59.4** — essentially invisible. Merchant listings do better (pos 3.2) but only 992 impressions. Product pages need the same content/linking investment as collections.

i 5. robots.txt / sitemap.xml 403

Still 403 to non-Google tools. Google itself is unaffected (the crawl data proves it). Lower priority than the earlier reports claimed — but still worth fixing so AI crawlers (OAI-SearchBot, PerplexityBot) and your own audit tools can access the site.

The Fix Plan — Reprioritized Around the Real Problem

The earlier plans led with "fix robots.txt / add schema." That was wrong. The real priority is **shifting equity from the blog to the commercial pages**.

● Phase 1 — Redirect the equity you already have (Weeks 1–3)

1. **Rebuild `/collections/custom-rolling-papers` into a real ranking page.** Add 500–800 words of genuine manufacturer content above/below the grid: materials (hemp / rice / unbleached), the customization process, MOQs, certifications, who it's for. This is the page that must climb from pos 18.5 → page 1.
2. **Internally link the blog → commercial pages.** Your 684 blog posts get 42,000 clicks/quarter. Right now that funnel is broken. Add a contextual, descriptive-anchor link (and a CTA block) from every relevant post to `/collections/custom-rolling-papers` and related collections. Even a 2–3% capture is meaningful revenue.
3. **Fix the `| within: collection` bug** (8 lines, listed above). Stops product link equity from splitting.
4. **Resolve homepage-vs-collection cannibalization.** Decide which page targets "custom rolling papers." Recommended: homepage stays brand/overview, collection page owns the commercial term — then link the homepage hero straight to the collection.

● Phase 2 — Stop the topical dilution (Weeks 2–6)

1. **Freeze new consumer/DIY/"alternatives" blog posts.** Every one further tilts Google's view of the site away from "manufacturer."
2. **Prune or consolidate the weakest informational posts.** 684 posts is a liability at this ratio. Consolidate near-duplicates (multiple "how to roll", "where to buy", "alternatives" posts) into fewer strong pages; 301 the rest.

3. **Add genuinely commercial content** — buyer guides aimed at dispensaries/brands: "How to order custom rolling papers", MOQ/lead-time comparisons, branding case studies.

 Phase 3 — Technical polish (Weeks 4–8)

- 1. Add Organization + BreadcrumbList JSON-LD; add SearchAction to WebSite .
- 2. Give product pages real content depth (they rank at pos 59).
- 3. Fix the homepage H1; one descriptive H1 per page.
- 4. Fix the robots.txt/sitemap 403 at the WAF; whitelist AI crawlers; add /llms.txt .
- 5. Run PageSpeed Insights on homepage + collection page (mobile) and address LCP/CLS.

Expected Impact

Action	What moves	Timeframe
Collection page content + internal links	/collections/custom-rolling-papers 18.5 → page 1; "custom rolling papers" 9.45 → 5–7	6–12 weeks
\ within: collection fix	Product pages consolidate equity; pos 59 → improving	4–8 weeks (recrawl)
Blog → commercial internal linking	Conversion of existing 42k clicks/qtr; revenue before rankings move	2–6 weeks
Stop dilution + prune	Google re-reads site as a manufacturer	1–2 core-update cycles

The opportunity: you already have the hard part — 45,500 clicks a quarter and a crawled, indexed site. You're routing almost none of it to pages that sell. Fix the internal routing and the commercial pages, and you convert existing demand without needing a single new visitor.

What I Still Can't See / Recommended Next Uploads

- **6-month trend** — re-export GSC with a custom 6-month range (this file was 3 months).
- **Collection & product page HTML** — to verify on-page content depth directly.
- **GSC Coverage / Indexing report** — to confirm what's indexed vs. excluded.
- **PageSpeed Insights** results for homepage + /collections/custom-rolling-papers .

Audit based on first-party data: Shopify theme export, homepage HTML source, and Google Search Console performance export (Feb 19–May 19, 2026). This is the authoritative report.